[METRIC]

A-A-56B
March 25, 1994
SUPERSEDES
A-A-56A
November 18, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STENOTYPE MACHINE PAPER
(PAPER, SHORTHAND MACHINE)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all Federal Agencies.

1. Scope: This description covers stenotype machine paper.

2. Salient characteristic:

2.1 The paper shall be one continuous strip in accordian folded form. Fold lines shall be at right angles to edge of paper. When used in a stenotype machine, nonassisting refold to occur during use, and figures, when printed, shall be legible and not smear. Paper shall be supplied as individually banded bundles.

Length between folds - 216 +/- 1.6 mm (8 1/2 +/- 1/16 inch)
Width of bundle - 60.3 +/- 1.6 mm (2 3/8 +/- 1/16 inch)
Thickness of bundle - 47.6 +/- 1.6 mm (1 7/8 +/- 1/16 inch)
Paper basis weight - 46-52 g/m^2 (28-32 lbs. (24x36-500))

2.2 Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data (See Ordering Data), the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

2.3 Workmanship. The end item shall be free of any defects such as, paper dust, grit spots, wrinkles, folds, holes, tears and smudges or any other defects that may affect appearance or serviceability. The edges of the end item shall not be nicked or uneven and shall be clean cut and lint free.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, N.Y. 10278.

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3. Quality Assurance Provisions. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

3.1 Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the plans as specified in Table 1, unless otherwise stated. For the purpose of sampling, a lot shall consist of stenotype machine paper. The sample unit shall be 1 continuous strip of stenotype machine paper for visual/workmanship and dimensional examination and one fully prepared shipping container for preparation for delivery examination, unless specified otherwise.

Table I

Examine	Inspection Levels	AQLs (% defective)
Visual/Workmanship defects	I	2.5
Dimensional defects	S-3	4.0
Basis Weight [1]	TAPPI	N/A

[1] Use TAPPI T410 for testing and with inspection level in accordance with TAPPI T400

4. Regulatory Requirements:

4.1 Certification. The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials including 20% post consumer materials in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (b), dated October 20, 1993 (See definition of post consumer materials and recovered materials in sections 203 and 205). As an alternative to meeting the standards of section 504(b) for all printing and writing papers, the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials that are a waste material byproduct of a finished product other than a paper or textile product which would otherwise be disposed of in a landfill, as determined by the State in which the facility is located, in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (c), dated October 20, 1993. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Recycled Content Labeling. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

5. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. Application for copies of technical documents referenced herein: The issue date in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall be apply.

(1) TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.

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(2) MIL-STD-105 is available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.
(3) Copies of Executive Order 12873, dated October 20, 1993 may be obtained from: The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building, White House, Att: Publications, Washington, DC. 20500 (202) 395-7332

7. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

A) Dimensions.
B) Whether bleaching without use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or chlorine compound is required.
C) Packaging, packing, labeling and marking.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

DOD has waived coordination of this document

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA-FSS

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